

The Woodlands Methodist School

Heat Related Illness Information

Heat-Related Illnesses Information

People suffer heat-related illness when their bodies cannot properly cool themselves by sweating. Sweating is the body's natural air conditioning, but when a person's body temperature rises rapidly, sweating just isn't enough. Heat-related illnesses can be serious and life threatening. Very high body temperatures may damage the brain or other vital organs, and can cause disability and even death. Heat-related illnesses and deaths are preventable.

Heat Stroke is the most serious heat-related illness. It happens when the body's temperature rises quickly and the body cannot cool down. Heat Stroke can cause permanent disability and death.

Heat Exhaustion is a milder type of heat-related illness. It usually develops after a number of days in high temperature weather and not drinking enough fluids.

Heat Cramps usually affect people who sweat a lot during demanding activity. Sweating reduces the body's salt and moisture and can cause painful cramps, usually in the abdomen, arms or legs. Heat cramps may also be a symptom of heat exhaustion.

Who's at Risk? Those at highest risk include the elderly, the very young, people with mental illness and people with chronic diseases. However, even young and healthy individuals can succumb to heat if they participate in demanding physical activities during hot weather. Other conditions that can increase your risk for heat-related illness include obesity, fever, dehydration, poor circulation, sunburn and prescription drug or alcohol use.

I have been advised of the dangers of participation for myself and that of my child/ward. The undersigned, on behalf of themselves, the other parent/guardian, the minor student and all assigns and representatives thereof, and to the fullest extent allowed by Texas Law do hereby knowingly accept the inherent risks presented by participation in this program and as a condition of such participation do hereby release and hold harmless the School Board/The Woodlands Methodist School, and all of its agents and employees from and against any and all lawsuits, claims, actions, damages or any other matter related to or arising out of the student's participation in this program, (the "Released Matters"), including Released Matters that are caused in whole or any part by the negligence of the School Board/School or any employee or agent thereof.

_____/_____/_____
Name of Student-Athlete (PRINT) Signature of Student- Athlete Date

_____/_____/_____
Name of Parent/Guardian (PRINT) Signature of Parent/ Guardian Date